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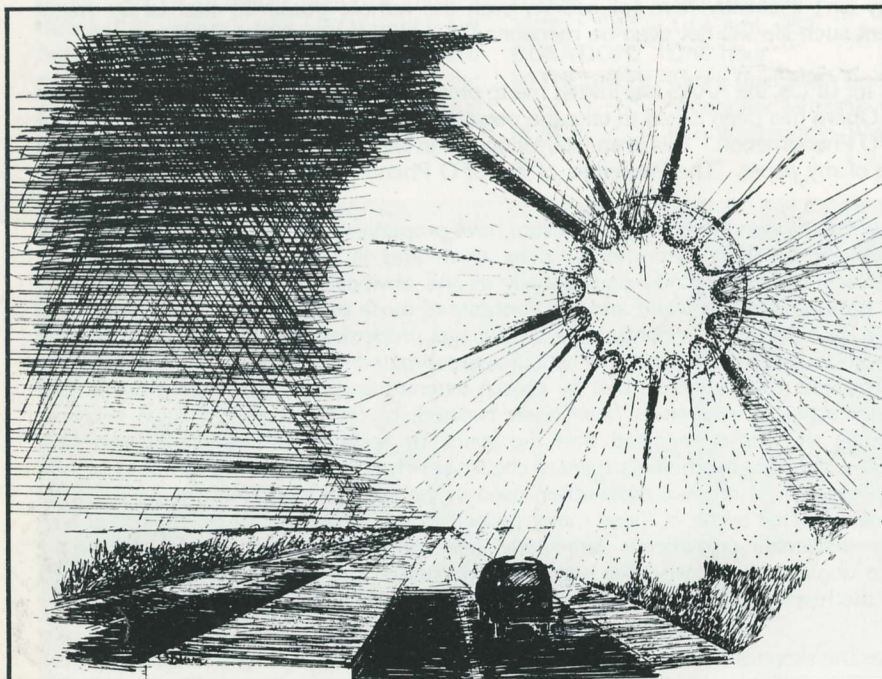
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NEBRASKA CLOSE ENCOUNTER

J. Allen Hynek

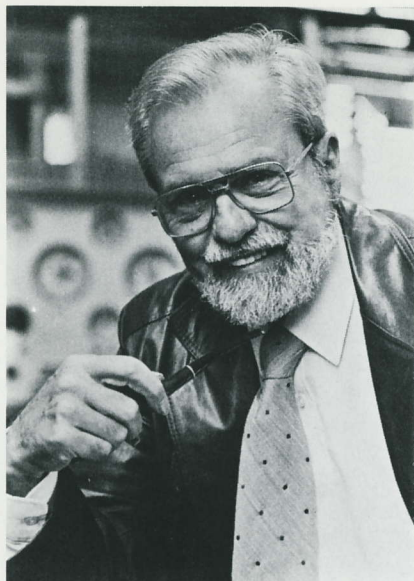
OUT OF PAST I.U.R.

DOUBLE ENCOUNTER QUESTIONED



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EDITORIAL

AAAS Preview

The American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS) will hold a special session on May 29, in the Trianon Ballroom of the New York Hilton, devoted to a look at the "Edges of Science." What are the edges of Science? That is what Isaac Asimov is to tell us in his introductory paper. The AAAS already knows: Parapsychology, the Search for Extraterrestrial Life, and UFOs.

The AAAS feels it has to cover all bases and so each topic will be given a pro and a con treatment. Dr. Stanley Krippner, professor of psychology, will hold that Parapsychology is a promising field to investigate while Randi, the magician (whose tenet is that if it can be done by magic, it was done by magic), will say that parapsychology is a doubtful premise.

Dr. Frank Drake, professor of astronomy at Cornell, will hold forth on the search for extraterrestrial life while Eric Jones, of Los Alamos, will hold that if there is extraterrestrial life, why isn't it already here (of course, even the remote possibility that UFOs might represent such life will not even be mentioned).

As for UFOs, the AAAS has invited me to present the case for UFOs, so to speak, and James Oberg has been asked to take the negative side. His paper is titled, "The Absence of a UFO Phenomenon." This is an interesting title in view of the fact that I have chosen as the title of my paper, "The Properties of the UFO Phenomenon."

How can a phenomenon that is absent have properties? The fact is, Mr. Oberg to the contrary, that a UFO phenomenon does exist, and is very much alive. The UFO Phenomenon can be defined operationally as the obvious and recorded flow of UFO reports from all over the world and the contents of those reports. That is the phenomenon, and its existence is incontestable. And it has properties, very definitely so. If I may quote from the abstract of my paper, which was submitted some time ago: "The contents of UFO reports...are characterized by certain inherent and unique patterns. Some 125 repeatedly reported properties have been isolated; of these some 25 have been so consistently and widely reported over the years, by responsible percipients, that they constitute a provocative multidisciplinary challenge. They have been found not to belong to the population of characteristics often used in the attempt to explain (away) the UFO Phenomenon. That some of these major properties do not appear to be consistent with the present scientific paradigm is particularly challenging, but because of that very fact the scientific community at large has summarily dismissed the entire phenomenon. In the light of the history of science, this may not be an entirely wise step."

If, as the skeptics hold, *all* UFOs are the result of misperception and misidentification, is it not strange that such misperceptions should show such consistent patterns...all over the world? And what are the misperceptions involved in the many EM cases on record; the many animal reaction cases on record? Do cows misperceive or hallucinate? Do car engines stop because they misperceive a twinkling star or an advertising plane? And what is being misperceived in a Close Encounter of the Third Kind?

The American Association for the Advancement of Science is to be congratulated for at least taking a look at these subjects on the edges of science, topics which have almost always been taboo. It is precisely by looking with open mind upon such topics that science may find some of its greatest advances.

People Who Live in Glass Houses . . . See UFOs

Ed. Note: The authors, both experienced ufologists, were asked to conduct an on-site investigation of this most interesting case shortly after I received a letter from the primary witness. Her letter was of interest not only because of her vivid account of the UFO event, but because it so well described the bewilderment and dismay of the witnesses, and also because it illustrates a changing attitude of the media toward the UFO subject.

It has long been known to ufologists that the more intelligent, educated, and solidly-based-in-reality witnesses are, the more disturbed and distraught they become when they are unable to find a rational explanation for it. If they can't find a good "answer," a barrier will exist between them and their friends and families; they won't be able to talk about their experience for fear of being thought deranged and "off the wall." In this particular case, the witness wrote and elaborated over the phone that "This didn't fit into my reality...I would not go to bed because I could not categorize this...I decided to watch it (the UFO) until it left because I knew it was not going to be a normal experience. I couldn't place the experience anywhere in my mind. I have never seen anything like this before."

by Donald R. Schmitt and Richard W. Heiden

As for the possible changing attitude of the press toward UFOs, she had written to me, "I was encouraged by Paul Hayes, science editor of the Milwaukee Journal, to report the occurrence to you." Of course, she could hardly have known the import of that statement. Not too many years ago, a good friend of mine, who had at one time been a reporter on the Milwaukee Journal, filed a story about an astronaut who told him of his sighting of a mysterious object while piloting a military plane. The reporter's story was killed because: "Our Science Editor does not believe in UFOs!" Maybe we are getting a new, enlightened, breed of science editors who know that open-mindedness is a virtue and not a vice.

TYPE: CE-I
DATE: Jan. 3, 1984
TIME: 4:14 A.M. CST
DURATION: One hour
WITNESSES: Three (including one secondary witness)
PLACE: Port Washington, Wisconsin

The primary witness is Ms. A., 30, a writer-artist who lives, with her husband, Mr. L., 38, a commercial artist, in a contemporary house on the shores of Lake Michigan, near Port Washington, Wisconsin. She described the house in her letter as being "almost entirely of glass, so there is an unobstructed view of the water from every room. It's a fairly isolated area in the winter since most residents are only here in the summer, so aside from us and a man who rents the beach house at the foot of the yard, it's pretty unpopulated." Mr. B., 34, the renter of the beach house, makes it his full-time residence. We went, with another Milwaukee-area CUFOS Associate, to interview all three witnesses, on the site, on Feb. 5, 1984.

Ms. A. was awakened by a bright light through the bedroom window. As is her habit, she immediately looked at her bedside digital clock to check the time. It was 4:14 a.m. As A. wrote in her Jan. 7 letter to Dr. Hynek: "When I looked through the curtains, I saw a strange craft with exactly three circular lights in a fixed position approximately 50 yards (50 feet, we learned later) from shore. It was lined up with our bedroom window and seemed to be the size of a medium-sized boat, or about 30 or 40 feet long. At first I thought it was the Coast Guard searching for something, but then the center light rotated north, casting a bright light upon the waters, and I noticed the water was rather turbulent."

Despite the rough water, the lights were not moving or bobbing up and down, so she knew that whatever it was, it was not resting on the water. From her past observations of the lake (they moved there in May, 1983), she realized "it was too close to shore to be a barge or carrier and too stationary to be a small boat." The water there is very shallow—only chest high—within 100 yards of shore. We also checked with the Coast Guard and the Port Washington police department, both of which have access to rescue boats, but all these boats had been taken out of the water for winter.

The three lights were, apparently, slowly turning clockwise around a 30-foot body. One of them was brighter, like a
(continued on page 16)



View from A. and L.'s bedroom window, showing the position of the "UFO" and its departure path, with an "X" where it paused on the way. Drawn by Don Schmitt on a Polaroid photo taken a month later, based on the sketches that the primary witness, Ms. A., made on clear overlays on this same picture. Unlike his wife, Mr. L. did not see the trees during the sighting, and thought that the "UFO" hovered near where the "X" is above, behind the picnic table. However, he independently drew a size that is the same as A's. B's beach house is on the left. The evergreen tree is just out of view to the right.

Boomerang Saga Continues

(Ed. note: The ongoing investigation of the very mysterious "Boomerang of Lights" that mystified hundreds of people in southern New York on March 24, 1983, was described in the July-August and September-October, 1983, issues of the REPORTER. That investigation has continued; a formidable number of man-hours have now been spent by Imbrogno and his team colleagues, Chris Clark and Police Lieutenant George Lesnick. I have spent two weekends in the area for on-site, face-to-face interviews with key witnesses, plus many hours on the phone. We all remain mystified.)

That is not to say that explanations haven't been offered. One in particular, and really the only seemingly tenable one, is that all of the numerous witnesses were hoodwinked and bamboozled by a formation of low-flying, light aircraft. In the two articles which follow, Imbrogno first discusses why he and his colleagues feel the

by Philip J. Imbrogno and Chris Clark

"plane formation" theory is completely untenable. Then Chris Clark tells of his investigation of one of the many sightings on that night. It is given here because it is representative of those sightings, differing only in details from the many others.)

Almost a year has passed since the mysterious boomerang-shaped UFO flew over the Westchester and Putnam counties in southern New York. Much information and documentation has been obtained since then through the efforts of the writers and our colleague, George Lesnick. Although the sightings actually cover a period of three months in all, we decided to concentrate on the sightings of March 24 since that evening had the most reports and the best witnesses. We are, however,

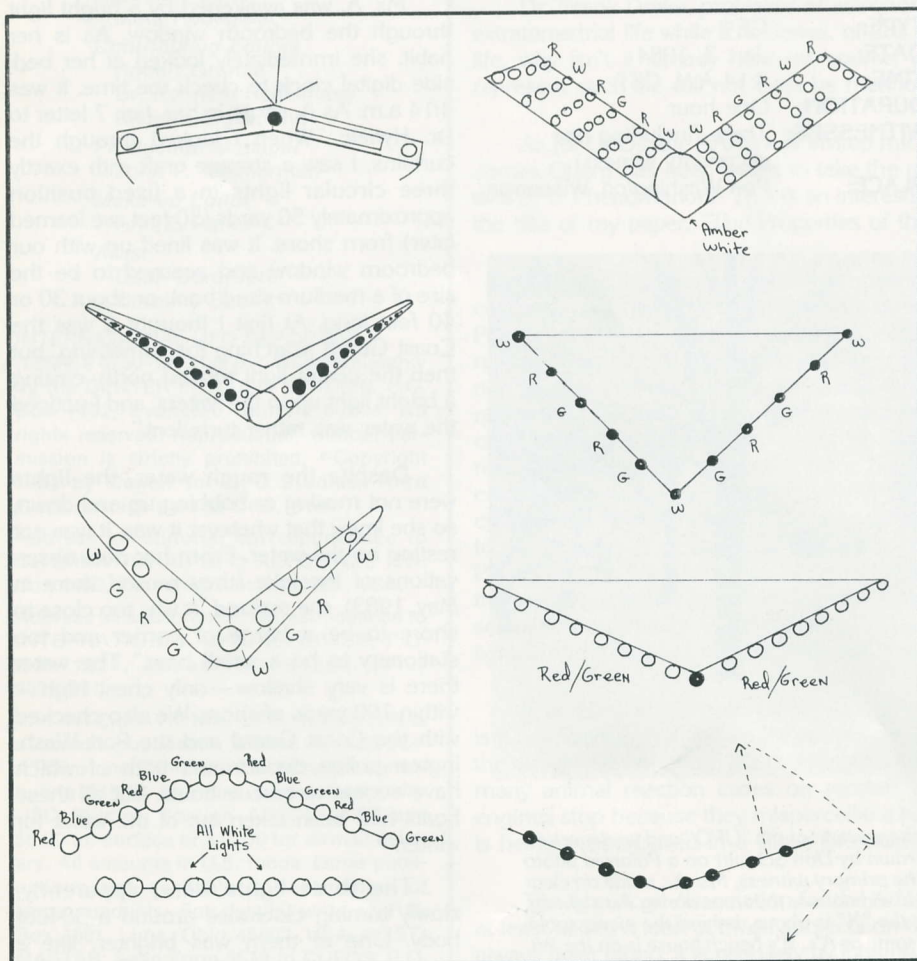
collecting some accounts from other days, those that were of well-observed events at close range and by responsible persons.

The object, whatever it was, still remains an unknown, but a great controversy has arisen (as with many UFO sightings). The theory advanced by law enforcement agencies in the area is that the lights were nothing more than a number of planes flying in a tight military formation. This theory has never been confirmed, and we can now demonstrate that it is next to impossible.

Apparently the sole origin of this explanation was dispatcher William Wolf, of the Yorktown police. On March 24 at 8:45 p.m., Wolf saw a formation of lights pass near the Yorktown police station. Here are segments taken from his statement included in a two-page police report:

"While on the desk relief I was told by Officer Soravilla that he saw a strange formation of red, green and yellow lights. The time was 8:45 p.m., and at this time I started to receive numerous calls from residents reporting a UFO flying very low and very slow. At this time, I went outside of headquarters and saw a formation of red, green and white lights that were approaching. As this formation came closer they all turned at once and it was apparent to me that they were five planes in formation."

We had a number of conversations with Officer Wolf shortly after the sightings. After much questioning, he stated that he assumed they were aircraft. He could not understand how they kept such a tight formation, especially when they made the turn. He thought that they might be military pilots, flying aircraft with a special type of muffler system to mask the engine noise. When the lights passed over his headquarters, he heard much less sound than he should have heard. Also, when the lights crossed in front of the moon, he could easily make out some type of structure which he thought looked like aircraft. (Given the speed of an aircraft and 1/2-degree angular diameter of the moon, he couldn't have identified any aircraft structure. At best, he would see a very dark outline which would pass his line of vision much too quickly to make a positive identification.)



So, as reports came in, Wolf told the callers that all they had seen were aircraft in formation flying from Stormville airport and knew it harbored many small planes. Once again, he assumed that is where they must be from. He also stated that he had talked with John Tower, supervisor of the Westchester County airport, who told him they had identified the lights as aircraft. Tower told me that they had no knowledge of what caused the UFO sightings.

It would appear that Officer Wolf is the sole source of the aircraft explanation (although others quickly adopted it). Since he is an officer of the law, many people and agencies (including other police stations in the area) took his word.

We learned that the Yorktown, Ossining, Putnam Valley, and Brewster police departments, as well as the New York State Police, each received no less than 50 reports that evening, so many that it was impossible to log each separately and caused worry lest the jamming of the phones with UFO calls might prevent regular police calls from coming through.

There were many variations on the "planes in formation" theme proposed. One of the first came from the State Police in Putnam County, New York, who said the sightings were caused by ultralight aircraft flying in formation from Stormville. Let us examine this particular idea:

An "ultralight" is nothing more than a hanglider with a motor and a seat. Ultralight flights are illegal after dark (the sightings were made between 8 and 10 p.m.). According to ultralight pilots and experts with whom I've talked, anyone flying them in formation at night and that low over a populated area would be insane. Ultralights are very unstable craft and the slightest amount of turbulence will cause swaying and make them very hard to control. How, then, could five of them stay in perfect formation? Also, ultralights cannot carry much weight and are just able to become airborne with a heavy man aboard. Furthermore, the UFO sported many lights of high intensity, which would make an ultralight too heavy to get off the ground. I was able to explain this in a local newspaper and, shortly thereafter, the ultralight theory was dropped, although not forgotten.

The origin of the flights was now changed; it became a formation of planes from Stewart Army Base, in Dutchess County, north of Stormville airport. Some

It may be many things, but the Boomerang is not planes flying in formation from Stormville airport.

unremembered persons told the Brewster and Carmel police that the lights were military planes being transferred to a base in New Jersey. It was said that the pilots were probably inexperienced in night flying and were following the Taconic Parkway (which runs north-south) so they wouldn't get lost. Would a flight commander let inexperienced pilots fly at night, in tight formation, over a populated area? Of course not! Also, New Jersey is south of Stewart Army Base, and the lights were seen going northward.

I called Stewart Army Airbase. Sergeant Fields, the Non-Commissioned Officer in charge of flight operations, almost laughed when I told him of this theory. There were no aircraft out that night, he said, and, in any case, they don't do formation flying.

With that explanation disposed of, Officer Wolf countered with a statement to the press reiterating his belief that the sighting was caused by planes from Stormville airport, adding that they must be excellent pilots with special training in flying close military formation. The whole thing, he said, was most likely a hoax. The absurdity that pilots with special military training would engage in such a hoax apparently escaped Wolf.

Stormville Airport?

This team of investigators visited Stormville on three different occasions (Ed. note: I was with them on one of the occasions), and each time we could find no evidence that the sightings were caused by aircraft from that airport. We talked with Albert Kruizinga, manager of the airport, who informed us that no formations that large have taken off from there. He knows

all the pilots who fly out of there and said that they were just as puzzled as we were about the sightings. He also stated that there is no Stormville Flying Club; such a club was said to be the culprits behind the UFO.

Radar?

The Westchester County airport, Purchase, New York, is the closest airport equipped with radar. John Tower, airport supervisor, told me no formations of aircraft were spotted that night. One small aircraft was tracked at about 1,500 feet above Yorktown at the time of the sighting. Whatever the UFO might have been, Tower said, it had not been tracked on radar. If, however, the object had stayed well below 1,500 feet altitude, it might well have gone undetected; the lower limit for their radar is 1,000 feet.

When at about 8:45 p.m. the tower began to receive numerous calls from police and residents of the area, it attempted to contact the "lights," on the assumption that they were ordinary aircraft (as identified by Wolf). They received no response, nor were they able to identify the lights as aircraft in formation.

The FAA?

The FAA in Dutchess County had little to add when I talked with several air traffic controllers and Mr. Feder, the Supervisor. They had seen the lights in the distance, but they also could make only visual contact. They assumed they were aircraft, but could not be sure. When I asked, "How do they keep such tight formation, yet go so slowly?" one controller said: "We haven't been able to figure that out, but whoever these guys are, they must be real good." When I asked how they explained the virtual absence of sound, their answer was: "I wonder how they do that!" As long as the lights stayed clear of restricted air space, I was told, they wouldn't do much about it. Their closing statement was, "We are continuing our investigation."

One of the flight operations staff said that they often sit around in the coffee room, talking about the lights, but that no one has come up with an answer.

Witnesses?

Most of the witnesses our team has talked with feel insulted by the aircraft-in-formation theory. Many are professionals (continued on page 6)

Boomerang — continued

with solid backgrounds. If we were dealing with a small number of witnesses with no technical/professional backgrounds, we might write off the entire case. But, we are dealing with a large number of witnesses, many of them with impressive technical/professional background.

One witness, eminently qualified to pass judgement on the airplane theory, is William Hele, chief meteorologist for the National Weather Corporation, located at the Westchester County airport. As an aviation weather expert, he is familiar with all types of aircraft. He rejects the airplane theory completely, as is obvious from this condensed transcript of his own sighting:

"I was driving south on the Taconic highway. As I approached route 134, I noticed a number of lights on the horizon moving very slowly from east to west. Since I am around aircraft quite a bit, anything in the sky that well-lighted aroused my curiosity. At this point, the object began approaching me; I realized that this was not any type of aircraft that I am familiar with. There seemed to be from five to seven lights arranged like a large check mark. As they approached, I heard no sound. I would estimate at this point that their altitude was about 1,000 feet, and making a forty-five degree angle from the horizon. The object then slowed down to a crawl, but was still moving, and the lights started changing all different colors as if a rotating prism was in the lights. No known aircraft has a rotating prism for a light source. At this point, the lights ceased to exist; they faded away quickly to zero lumens. I started scanning the skies, looking for something. I could not even see a dark outline or silhouette of an object against the sky. I suppose 30 or 40 seconds elapsed when all of a sudden... FLASH...the entire string of lights came

on. I was alone on the road at the time and I started to get just plain scared. I would estimate the object was about 1,000 feet directly above me. It subtended an angle so large in the sky that it led me to believe that it was about a quarter of a mile long. If the lights in fact were connected by some type of structure, I could not see it. The object continued to hover for a half-dozen or more seconds and then it began to drift slowly north. Then two young men came running up to me, screaming, 'Mister, do you have a camera!!!' They told me that they had been following the object for some time. The object then slowly drifted toward the horizon and was lost to view."

It is clear that whatever Mr. Hele saw was not any type of conventional aircraft. His testimony is corroborated by that of 30 other witnesses who were independent of each other along a stretch of Taconic Parkway (which runs through the towns of Briarcliff Manor, Ossining, Yorktown, and Millwood, New York). All of these towns are in Westchester county.

Approximately 15 minutes before the Hele sighting, the object (or a similar one) was seen near Stormville airport, the northernmost sighting of March 24th. Three witnesses state that they got to within 200 feet of the object which hovered above their heads for 10 minutes...a really close encounter!

(Ed note: Because of space limitations in this issue and because we await sketches and further details from Imbrogno and Clark, including a five-hour interview, we will continue this Saga in the next issue. This spectacular sighting, referred to in the last paragraph, we wish to examine more closely in its relation to the panoply of other sightings made farther to the south that same evening.) □

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LETTERS

"A War with the Unknown"

Dear Dr. Hynek:

I am a 37-year old housewife in Rockford, Illinois, who has two children, and I am married to an attorney. I cannot tell you how pleased I was to read the article in the newspaper about your coming to Rockford to talk to the people in Byron who sighted UFOs. If only there was someone like you to talk to years ago when I had an experience! Over the years I have told my "story" to only a few trusted friends (who looked at me like I was crazy) and to my husband who cannot comprehend nor logically deal with what happened to me...The reason I'm writing you is to finally tell this to someone who understands and possibly to shed some light on your research. I hope that others who have remained silent will also contact you.

In 1966, outside of Peoria, Illinois, my boyfriend (who I dated for three years) and I were parked in an isolated area. I had driven there in my car which was a convertible and we were busy kissing when suddenly the brightest light I've ever seen was over some nearby trees. I remember feeling sharp pain in my eyes and my date telling me not to look and to get the "_____ " out of there..

Later, we decided to contact a scientist my date knew at the Argonne National Laboratory, and we went to his office to meet with him. He also had another man in the office who taped our story and who told us that all we had seen was light reflecting off ground fog (it was a clear star-filled sky and warm out...and we were in a very isolated area...no lights to be reflected!) and that the figures we had seen were simply deer. My response to that was that I had never seen deer wearing patches. We were angry at the fact that there was nobody to tell our story to, and we also felt that making any more waves would not only embarrass us but possibly our parents.

My friend and I kept in touch until 1968, when we broke up. We were students at the University. We will never forget what happened, and I've never had any other experience. [See "Out of the Past"].
(continued on page 9)

UFO Hotline Reports

Beginning with this issue, we will include, as space permits, a current report from Robert Gribble's National UFO Reporting Center in Seattle, Washington. These reports are uninvestigated as of the date of publication, but will give our Associates a quick glimpse at the nature of sighting reports being received. Alternate monthly reports are published in the CUFOS ASSOCIATE NEWSLETTER. The names of witnesses are on file and will be released only with their permission.

Jan. 21, 1984 — 9:30 PM — Near Jasper, New York: While driving home to Edison, a mother and two children watched in amazement as an enormous gold, oval-shaped object appeared to pace their car. As they watched, the object appeared to land on a nearby ridge and after a few seconds it ascended into the sky. The mother said the object repeated this maneuver several times and when she increased and decreased the speed of the car, the object did the same. At one time the object moved across the sky, then returned to the area near her car.

Jan. 22, 1984 — 7:25 AM — 30 Miles East of Toledo, Ohio: The cabin crew of United Airlines flight 729, flying west-bound at 43,000 feet, observed a blurry bright red object about the size of a DC-9 airliner move from northeast to southwest. The object, which was in view for only a few seconds, left a contrail which the airliner passed through.

Jan. 22, 1984 — 7 PM — Near Waycross, Georgia: While parked in a wooded area, a young couple spotted a large object approaching their car at treetop level. The object crossed the logging road near their car, went across an open area to a stand of trees, then turned end-for-end. At this point the driver put the car in gear and started down the road at a high rate of speed. Then the object made its way back toward the road and took a position directly over the car at a very low altitude. The object had an L-shaped light pattern on the underside with two brilliant red lights and one green light. The glow from the red lights lit up the inside of the car and both occupants became hysterical. When the car reached the county road, the driver turned left and the object turned right. Then the object swung around and moved in behind the car and followed the fleeing vehicle for about 75 feet, turned left, and moved away at a high rate of speed. The sheriff's office received several calls about a strange lighted object in the area that night.

By Bob Gribble

Jan. 22, 1984 — 7 PM — Arnold, Missouri: Two occupants of a car observed a circular object with three brilliant white lights and a corona of white light covering its entire surface. As the object approached the car the driver made a 180 degree evasive turn only to have the object pull alongside and pace his vehicle. After about three minutes the object pulled away and left the area. The driver estimated that the object got to within 150 feet of the car, maintained an altitude of about 150 feet and was at least 25 feet in diameter. A vertical shaft of white light was also observed coming from the top of the object. After arriving home the two witnesses observed three helicopters moving about in the area where the object was seen.

January 22, 1984 — 7:09 AM — Huntington, West Virginia: on the way outdoors to start his car the witness observed a large brilliant ball of orange light in a stationary position about 900 feet above the neighbors house. The glow from the ball illuminated the entire ground area. After watching the object for about a minute it suddenly moved to the west at a high rate of speed. He detected no sound coming from the object.

Jan. 27, 1984 — 5:40 AM — Valley Center, California: Four witnesses observed five large, brilliant, stationary white lights in the northern sky. Four of the lights were in a diamond formation with the fifth light in the center of the formation. After watching the display for several minutes they noticed smaller white lights maneuvering around the large lights. The small lights increased in number to a total of about 100 within a few minutes. Suddenly the formation moved away to the northwest and was accompanied by the small lights. As the formation started to move the witnesses detected a soft humming sound. When first sighted the lights were estimated to be two miles distant. The observation lasted for about eight minutes.

Jan. 27, 1984 — 6:15 AM — King Of Prussia, Pennsylvania: Two young boys delivering papers observed a big circular object with lights around the edge hovering over houses about two blocks distant. They watched the object for several seconds,

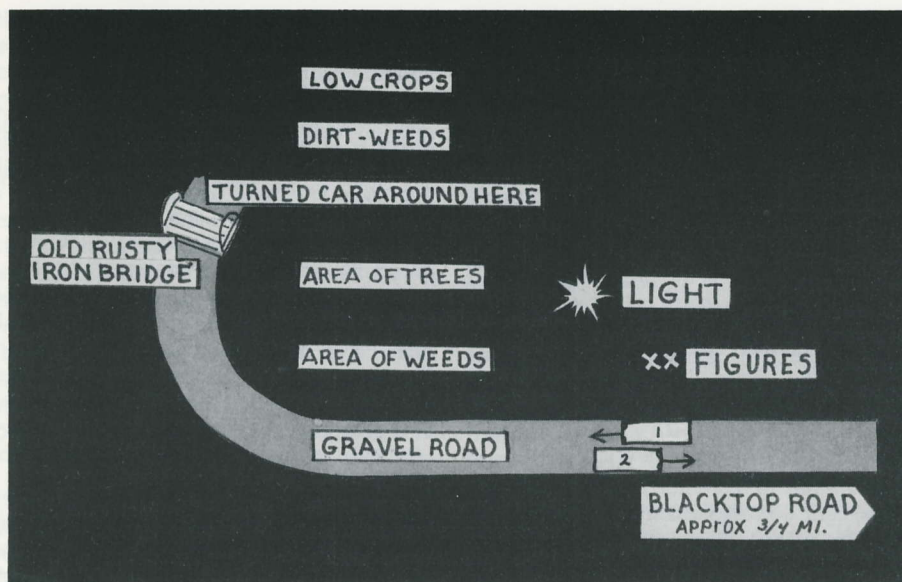
then it ascended into the sky at about a 45 degree angle. The boys did not detect any sound.

Jan. 28, 1984 — 6:30 PM — Flemington, New Jersey: A young couple sighted an orange ball descending through the cloud layer and appeared to land on a ridge behind the tree line. Twenty minutes later the husband observed a big, bright object ascending vertically from the same ridge, pause in mid-air, then move horizontally and disappear in the distance. The object that descended appeared to be as big as a hot air balloon. (The Center received 55 calls from a 15 county area describing the descent of a glowing object over New Jersey.)

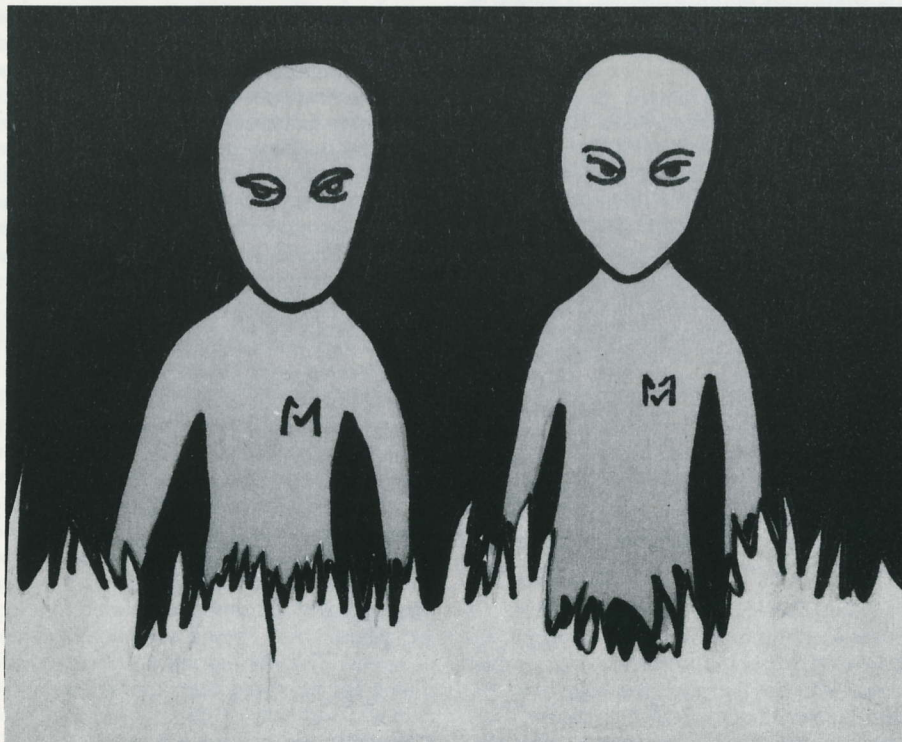
Jan. 30, 1984 — 9 PM — 40 Miles West of Miami, Florida: Nine men working on an oil platform observed a bright orange object descending from the sky at a high rate of speed. When at an estimated altitude of 10,000 feet and about five miles distant, the object came to an instant stop. The bright orange glow faded and the crew observed an object with a bright chrome dome-shaped top and dozens of flashing lights on the underside. All witnesses agreed that the object was huge; no less than 200 feet in diameter. After remaining stationary for about ten seconds the object turned a bright orange and instantly moved away to the east at a high rate of speed. The total observation time was about one minute. (A witness at Jensen Beach, about 100 miles northeast of the oil platform, observed the object dropping from the sky in a high speed vertical descent. Two witnesses in the Miami area also saw the object; one while the object was stationary west of Miami and the other while the object was moving to the east.)

Feb. 7, 1984 — 4 AM — Atco, New Jersey: The witness awoke to a loud humming sound and found his room illuminated by a bright light. He got out of bed and went to the window and saw a bright white circular object with a hump on top in a stationary position about four feet above his neighbors yard. He estimated that the object was about 200 feet from him and the size of a small car. He saw an image like a man next to the object. The image vanished and the object ascended in a zig-zag pattern, then moved away at a high rate of speed. The witness felt he observed the object for no more than ten seconds. He checked with the neighbors and they said they didn't see or hear anything. □

Out of the Past



"So I turned the car around and stepped on the gas. We had to go right past where we had been parked . . . I saw two grey figures with large slanted eyes and with square insignia, near the heart area."



TYPE: CE-III
 DATE: Fall, 1966
 TIME: Night
 DURATION: 2-3 minutes
 WITNESSES: 2
 PLACE: Rockford, Illinois (rural)

This is the case referred to in "Letters." It is remarkable how often a couple, generally young, whose thoughts are far from the subject of UFOs, have a UFO experience burst upon them. Also characteristic are the great reluctance to talk about the experience for fear of ridicule and, as part of the same familiar scenario, the palid and generally senseless "explanations" offered by the "experts."

The scenario begins as dozens of others have: a young couple, parked in as lonely a place as they can find... "When we parked we always made sure there would be complete privacy, so we wouldn't be interrupted or a policeman wouldn't be coming along." They were a mile or so from the nearest hard-top road. The night was clear and starry and light enough so that the trees and brush could be seen easily.

"The only reason we looked up was because of the sudden bright light. The light was very bright, like when someone is welding. It hurt my eyes. All we wanted to do was to get out of there. I started the car and we drove across an old metal bridge (see drawing) only to discover that it was a dead end...the road went into farm fields. So I turned the car around and stepped on the gas. We had to go right past where we had been parked."

It was at this moment that both of them saw the 'aliens.' "I saw two grey figures with large slanted eyes and with square insignia, near the heart area." The primary witness, who holds a Masters degree in art, drew the accompanying "portrait." Although they didn't stop as they passed the critical spot, the witness told me in the course of our interview that the images were permanently blazoned on her memory...she could never forget them. The light, which had appeared to be coming from tree top height, was gone, and no "craft" was visible.

"I didn't feel threatened at the time of the sighting. As much as I wanted to flee the area, I felt safe near it." This, many readers will recall, is a frequent reaction.

No sound had broken the stillness that surrounded them in their isolation. As they left, however, they smelled a very pungent, 'super-metallic' odor like "sulfur or iron." Also, as they left, "the hair on my arms and head felt like it was standing on end."

How has this affected her life, and what does she think about it now that many years have passed? "I have tried to block this out, in order to live as sane and normal a life as I can. I'm married to a respectable attorney..." The implication is clear: one does not talk about strange UFO experiences in the real, practical everyday world! The relief that now, after so many years, she was able to relate her story to someone who finds her a credible person, was obvious during our interview. How many other UFO stories are at this moment pent up in people's memories, waiting for the "right time" to be told!

Letter—continued

My friend and I kept in touch until 1968, when we broke up. We were students at the University. We will never forget what happened, and I've never had any other experience. [See "Out of the Past"].

Recently, I saw the interview with Carl Sagan after the showing of "The Day After." As pressing as the thought of nuclear war is, I have never understood why more information is not released from the government regarding UFOs. My point is that while we are worried about which country is going to push the button to start a nuclear war, we have already been in a "war" of sorts with the unknown. How can you "fight" a peeping Tom who never leaves any concrete proof except vague sightings which are as hard to document as mine is, or scorched circles on the earth?

L.K.
Rockford, Illinois

All of science is essentially a "war" with the unknown but, as indicated in the present Editorial, that unknown must be "acceptable" to the scientific community; otherwise it is left untouched—Ed.

Norway Lights Continue:

Just before going to press, we put in a call to Odd-Gunnar Roed, coordinator of Project Hessdalen, in Duken, Norway (about 60 miles from Oslo) to learn the latest results of the around-the-clock watch being maintained in the dark, dead of Norwegian winter. We learned that he had just returned from the observing camp and that the latest sighting had occurred just two days before our call, and that during the first week of February they had two radar-visual events, clocking the rapidly moving lights at 28,000 and 16,000 km (17,500 and 10,000 miles) per hour. "It's amazing," Mr. Roed told us, "you can go up there and get sightings just like you order them."

He said that there has been no essential change in the nature of the lights, but, because of their frequency and localized nature, there has been much discussion in the press as to whether the lights are the result of some natural phenomenon. (In the last analysis, isn't everything in the universe, by definition, natural? At present, their origin is unknown, so also by definition, they are UFOs.)

Project Hessdalen has now been able to round up some observing equipment: many cameras, an elementary spectrograph, a magnetometer, a radio-frequency spectrum analyzer, and a seismograph. Roed said that reports and photos are on the way, as is their latest Bulletin.

The last Project Hessdalen Bulletin received at the Center, dated Dec. 12, 1983, stated that the observing sessions would start right after the Holidays and warned that "all personnel must stay there (Hessdalen) at their own risk; we cannot be responsible for people showing up in Bermuda shorts and with only an ideological working spirit...the temperature goes down to minus 30 Celsius (22 below zero F.) and sometimes even lower."

The Bulletin also states that they have gained the cooperation of the Norwegian Defense Research Establishment, and that the Norwegian Air Force has taken a serious interest in the Hessdalen phenomenon. They have also obtained the support of the local population, whose interest has extended even as far as the organizing of Bingo games, with profits going to the Project.

It is logical that the government should express interest, since here they have something relatively tangible and, of greatest importance, repeatable, and, therefore, available for scientific study. For those very reasons, however, the solution to the Hessdalen lights is likely to be mundane and not extra-terrestrial. The fact remains, however, that at present they are a mystery. Merely to dismiss them as rapidly traveling globules of plasma is but to label them, not to explain them. What is their cause? Why do they travel at such speeds? Why do they occur there and not all over Norway? Why do they have a preferential direction (one is here reminded of the "green fireballs of New Mexico" which also had a preferential direction and location but were labelled... and, therefore, presumably solved...as meteors).

There no longer appears to be any question as to the genuineness of the phenomenon. Photographs have been taken with several cameras and by several independent photographers. There also appears, however, to be no little question that mixed in with the genuine there has been much naivete and wishful thinking on the part of the public and the UFO buffs. Not everything that glitters is a Hessdalen light.

The "King's Loyal Opposition" in this area comes in the form of NIVFO, the (continued on page 12)

Update on Project Hessdalen

See Nov.-Dec., 1983 INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER

Nebraska Close Encounter

by J. Allen Hynek

“Who expects to see something like this at 3 in the morning?”

“It looked like something out of the comic books, something out of Hollywood ...like from the set of the movie *Close Encounters*.”

“It’s so hard to tell people what you saw, then have them tell you you’re from *Twilight Zone*! That’s why I gave up talking about this whole thing.”

So the three witnesses to this *Close Encounter* reported to me in independent interviews. Yet, what the witnesses described to me, although they were unaware of it, was typical of the “traditional” *Close Encounters of the First Kind* and the way in which they occur. We’ve heard the scenario time and time again: out driving late at night; rural area far from cities and towns; bright, colored lights floodlighting the immediate area...lights you just wouldn’t expect to find out on open farmland; complete bewilderment on the part of the witnesses; and, finally, great reluctance to talk about the UFO event. And we ask the same questions. Is it possible that this really happened? Could it be a hoax? Was this something quite normal and ordinary, but somehow misperceived simultaneously, and in the same way, by three people? Or was this a *real* UFO?

The names of the witnesses are a part of our records, but their use has been understandably denied. The principals came from upper economic and social levels, and they would have no reason to concoct such a story. It would act only to their detriment, and its circulation could lead only to ridicule. Someday it will be acknowledged that UFO events like this do happen, whatever their cause. Then, witnesses of this caliber can speak out without fear; the ridicule curtain will be gone.

TYPE: CE-I
DATE: Jan. 8, 1984
TIME: 3:15 a.m.
DURATION: 1+ minutes
WITNESSES: 3
PLACE: I-80, near Cozad, Nebraska

Five people were returning from a skiing trip in Colorado (where they have a condominium) to their home in a southern suburb of Chicago. Two of the five were asleep in the large van, which they use for frequent trips to Colorado, and did not awaken in time to see the UFO. Maureen, a senior in college, was driving and her boyfriend, James, was in the front passenger seat. Maureen’s mother was riding in back of them, dozing. She became alarmed when Maureen began making incoherent noises, thinking that a crash was imminent.

“I thought we must be hitting something,” the mother reported. “I looked and saw this brilliant light...the whole highway was lit up. And here we were approaching this monstrous circular disk with many lights on it. At that instant I thought ‘What has happened to us? Have we entered another world?’ The thought went through my mind, ‘Have we died?’”

One of our artists, Caroline Baum, has drawn a composite from three independent sketches made by the witnesses. The three witnesses were fairly consistent in their descriptions, despite the fact that Maureen did not stop the car. (She slowed to 15-20 m.p.h. as she stared in wonderment at this apparition. All said later that they were sorry they hadn’t stopped for a longer look.)

The object was, they said, as large as a baseball diamond; had it landed, they indicated, it would have covered the eastbound lanes and shoulder of I-80 and a part of the neighboring field. The lights were evenly spaced along the rim of the UFO, and all three were insistent that some of the lights were distinctly pink, others blue, but that the majority were white. The object was not rotating, but its motion, if any, would have been small. As the car passed nearly under it, (its estimated height above the road was 75 to 100 feet) at a slow speed, they did not detect any motion of the object itself. They had a good view of the bottom and a part of the sides, but the top was entirely hidden. They heard no noise.

When Maureen first spotted it, she was some 30 seconds away from it and traveling 55 m.p.h. or better. It then appeared as a very bright light, which she thought might be some sort of a bright billboard along the side of the road.

“When I got close enough to see the lights separately, I was right under it,” she said. “The lights were all the same...except for color. There was a blank space between each of the lights. The craft seemed to be a light gray and each of the lights was circular...like lighted globes.” (When pressed, she indicated they were about the apparent size of the moon.)

“About 30 seconds after we passed it and I got my senses back, I called out on the CB (radio) and asked if anyone had seen anything near mile marker 236. I didn’t go into detail...they might have thought I was a little off. But, nobody had seen anything. Yet, there was a car in front of me that I caught up with, so possibly they saw it but didn’t have a CB.”

In my interview, I tried to have Maureen compare the object to some more familiar object, but this was difficult for her. “It was very, very Hollywood-looking...like something out of the comic books.”

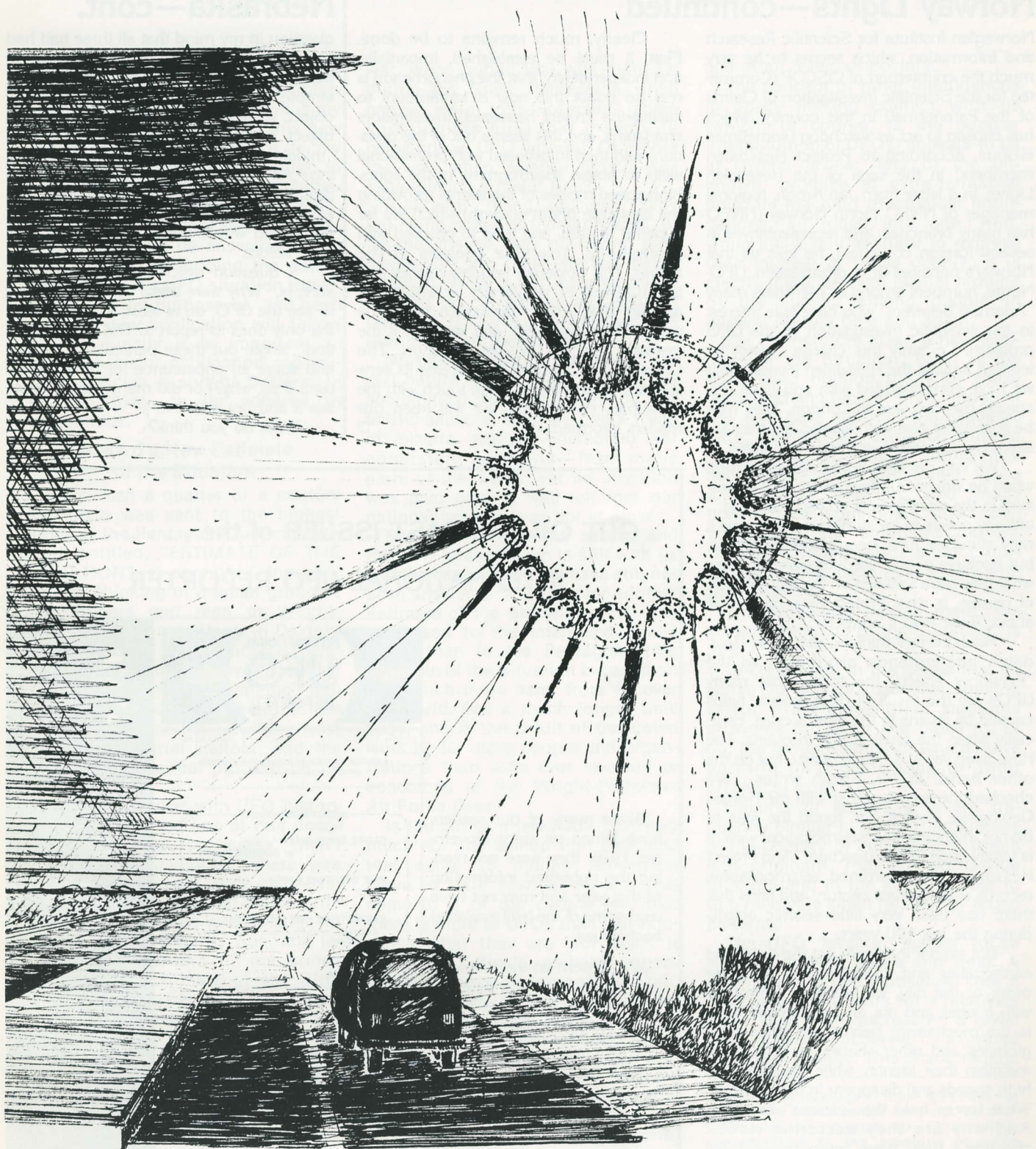
In talking with Maureen’s mother, the reference to Hollywood again came up; this, in turn, rather naturally brought up the movie, “*Close Encounters of the Third Kind*.” I asked whether she had ever seen it. She replied: “Yes, and I laughed at it! But now, after having gone through this, I realize I had about the same reaction as the actors in the movie had...you know, when they climbed the mountain and were looking down on the UFO.”

The day after the sighting, when the party had returned to their Illinois home, Maureen’s mother called the Center, and there ensued several long telephone interviews. Our usual practice of going to the actual site, of course, was not feasible in this case. On the basis of the telephone interviews, however, there remained no

(continued on page 12)

ESTIMATE OF THE SITUATION

by D. J. Allen



Norway Lights—continued

Norwegian Institute for Scientific Research and Information, which seems to be very much the counterpart of CISCOP (Committee for the Scientific Investigation of Claims of the Paranormal) in this country, which has chosen to act as watchdog (sometimes vicious, according to Project Hessdalen members) in the saga of the Hessdalen Lights. In a letter from Jan Krogh, regional manager of NIVFO North Norway (NIVFO has many branches, and representatives in several foreign countries), he tells us that Norway's principal UFO organization, UFO-Norge, numbers among its members many "Adamski believers" who have little interest in the scientific investigation of the UFO problem. Certainly this charge cannot be levelled against the Hessdalen investigators we have corresponded with and have personally met last year in London. They may be somewhat over-enthusiastic, but they are sincerely devoted to scientific principles.

We can certainly agree with Mr. Krogh when he writes: "Ufology must be a profession in the word's most correct meaning... ufology needs to be studied not because it may show we have been visited by aliens, but because people are interested to know what they have watched on the sky." Which, of course, is what Project Hessdalen is all about, if we read it correctly.

Much current thinking about the Hessdalen phenomenon ascribes it to the "Persinger effect," the theory that many UFOs are the result of piezo-electric fields caused by strains in the earth's crust, especially when the crust is rich in quartz. The Hessdalen valley is rich in quartz, but on the other hand, as Mr. Krogh writes, "We checked the area together with the Norges Geologiske Institutt and found the area to be not interesting in a seismological view. It is totally dead in that direction." And Project Hessdalen has examined seismographic records over the past century and finds that there has been very little seismic activity during the last 100 years.

But even if that were not the case, and earthquakes and crustal strains were the order of the day, we still deal essentially with a label, and not an explanation. What is the mechanism behind the large scale globules and other shapes of light which maintain their identity while they travel at high speeds and disappear in the distance? What forces hold the "plasma" together? And why are they occurring now... shouldn't they have been present for centuries?

Clearly, much remains to be done. First, it must be established, impartially, and independently, that the phenomenon is real (to doubt this now is tantamount to calling the Project Hessdalen investigators charlatans, and this seems out of the question) and then to proceed with professional skills to obtain spectrograms of the lights, high speed movies of the events (providing the lights are bright enough) which are far superior to stills, and then to proceed with professional scientific analysis of the results. This obviously requires money and the interest of university scientists. It appears that Project Hessdalen is on the way to obtaining both, and we wish it the greatest success in that direction. The Center for UFO Studies has offered its services and is keeping in close touch with the principals concerned. We will keep our readers informed. □

Nebraska—cont.

question in my mind that all three had had an extremely unusual and frightening experience which would be hard to ascribe to simple misperception of some ordinary object. What brilliantly lighted conventional object is one likely to encounter in the "middle of nowhere" at three in the morning? All three witnesses gave consistent descriptions of something that was very close, very large, brilliantly lighted, and something which none of them had ever seen before.

A question which bothers us all, I'm sure, is, "Why were these the only persons to see the UFO, or, at least, why were they the only ones to report it? Did this "apparition" single out these particular witnesses and stage an appearance for their benefit (and if so, why?) or did many more people see it and not admit to it?"

What do you think? □

OUT OF THE PAST ISSUES of the

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER



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A MONTHLY REVIEW OF THE UFO PHENOMENON
REPORTS, INVESTIGATIONS & ANALYSES

"There is no hope of advance in science without a paradox." —Neil Bohr

IN OUR PREMIERE ISSUE:

**CLOSE ENCOUNTER
IN CONNECTICUT**

**FIVE UFO'S SELECTED
FROM 102 CASES**

ESTIMATE OF THE SITUATION
Dr. Hynek's introductory article on the state of the UFO art

ON REVIEW:
BEHAVIOR AND PERCEPTION IN STRANGE ENVIRONMENTS

PLUS:
Foreign Forum,
UFO Profile: September, 1976
Latest UFO News

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EDITORIAL



by Dr. J. Allen Hynek

Whatever one may think about UFOs—whatever one may believe about their physical reality—whatever one may speculate about their origins, one fact has stood out over the past quarter of a century: UFOs continue to intrigue, mystify, entrance and engage our imaginations. Even the skeptic can barely fail to sense the dramatic element in a well-documented, multiply-witnessed report of a UFO close encounter. Almost always, each new UFO report bears some relation to previous reports, yet each is a new challenge to the inquiring mind. It is a challenge, but it is also a threat to established ways of looking at things, to our present conception of reality. Each well-investigated UFO report (which means that all reports for which a rational explanation has been found have been eliminated) carries us closer to the edge of reality. It suggests that conventional ways of looking at things, what we accept as reality, may have to be changed, much in the same way that Einstein presented us with a new way of looking at the physical world. It suggests the need for a shift in outlook and for an allowance for things not yet known. Each age has had its change in scientific outlook, in its "world-view," and the UFO phenomenon may well point the way to the next such change.

What that change might be we can find only by diligent research. Quick guesses or wishful thinking will not do—only well-supported, well-executed research will eventually yield answers. It is becoming increasingly clear that the UFO is much more than that which merely fools the eye or deuces the fool. Much more—it is entirely new information, and only the unprejudiced mind is prepared to take advantage of, and meet, this new challenge.

J. Allen Hynek

ESTIMATE OF THE SITUATION

by Dr. J. Allen Hynek

Welcome, charter subscribers, to this, the first issue of the International UFO Reporter (IUR). It is my pleasure to welcome you to this new and exciting venture, and it is my duty, as Editor and as a scientist, to set forth the purposes and philosophy of this new publication. WHY, the International UFO Reporter?

This can best be answered, I believe, by first describing the nature and state of the UFO situation today. From this the purpose of, and need for, this new publication will follow clearly. Finally it is important to establish major publication and editorial policies, a sort of Declaration of Principles, to be adhered to throughout.

Toward a New Estimate of the Situation

More than a quarter of a century ago there was sent to the highest levels of the Pentagon a secret document entitled, "ESTIMATE OF THE SITUATION". It contained the considered thinking of a small group of the officers and men at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, in Dayton, Ohio, who had been concerned with the sudden influx of "flying saucer" reports. This group "estimated" that the situation was indeed serious: the planet Earth was the unwilling host to extra-terrestrial visitors, and the Air Force had a real problem on its hands.

Readers familiar with UFO history know the reported fate of this document. The very top "brass" didn't accept its conclusions. There was no "hard" evidence, they said,—no compelling evidence that the security of the United States was threatened. Since national security was, and is, the primary concern of our armed forces, the "Estimate of the Situation" was killed and the few copies in existence destroyed. If one remains, it would be a collector's item indeed.

Apparently no one in these higher circles of national defense evinced any curiosity about the great flow of reports themselves: why now (1947-8) and not at some other time? Why not, for instance, during the

war, when public fear was high. Or during the Great Depression when people were truly insecure [some sociologists hold that insecurity helps spawn UFO reports]. Or before the war, when science fiction was experiencing a major rise?

And why "flying saucers"? Why not flying tables or flying garages, or for that matter, why not flying pink elephants? But these weren't being reported. What is *not* reported might be just as important as what is reported. No satisfactory answer was ever given to these questions.

No one seemed to care about the real nature of the phenomenon, its sociological, psychological, and scientific aspects. Here we had a flood of bizarre reports—incredible yet consistent accounts—from many parts of the world, yet no attention was paid once it was felt that our national security was not at stake.

Much time has since passed and the UFO phenomenon is still with us and the basic questions have still not been answered. It is time for another Estimate of the Situation, this time addressed to the interested public rather than to the Pentagon. This Estimate of the Situation is based on very much more data, from all over the world, has a much longer time base, and is the result of dedicated work by far more people and organizations than were ever involved or concerned at the Wright-Patterson Air Force Base.

Is the public interested? Yes, very much so. The Gallup Poll indicated that some 15 million Americans claim to have seen UFOs and that some 51% of the people feel that there is more to UFOs than just nonsense—that they are "for real". It would be difficult, perhaps impossible, to find another single, specific (non-sex related!) subject which for more than a quarter of a century has had as much printer's ink used up on it, caused as much discussion and argument, sometimes with tempers fraying, had as many wry and caustic remarks made about it, has been the point of as many jokes and cartoons, or has had as many queries raised about it, as has the subject of UFOs,

and at all levels of society.

The concept of other intelligences in space making contact with us (which, of course, is the popular interpretation of UFOs) appeals to us at several levels: fear of the unknown, promise of extra-terrestrial help, far-reaching theological implications, all rolled into one. And, while many still hesitate to express their interest in UFOs openly, it is clearly there, as even casual probing of the subject among people in general reveals time and again.

Let us therefore make a new Estimate of the Situation. What is the considered opinion today of these dedicated and technically competent few who have studied* the available data, weighed the evidence with an open mind, after fully taking into account the many stupidities, loose and wishful thinking, and many honest (and sometimes dishonest) mistakes of the untutored and the "mentally tilted" who, most unfortunately, have been associated with the subject.

The consensus among them, the present Estimate of the Situation, is this:

UFOs are real in the sense that an actual but unexplained phenomenon exists. Truly unidentified sightings of events in the air and close to, or on, the ground (some of which leave definite physical traces of their presence) exist.

Reports of such events are frequently similar in content regardless of the country or culture from which they originate. They are world-wide in origin and in the main, appear to fit a relatively small number of broad patterns.

The UFO "events" appear to be isolated in both space and time. A given event is rarely observed over a wide area and it lasts for a relatively short time. For this reason, a given event is usually observed by a limited number of people. This characteristic

* Clearly, the opinions of those who have not studied the phenomenon need not be considered, any more than one would give serious consideration to the opinions of a TV comedian on the subject of quantum mechanics.

is well established but has often led to the out-of-hand dismissal of the subject on the grounds that "if UFOs are 'real', why aren't they seen in more places and by more people?" That is indeed one of the primary questions research into UFOs seeks to answer.

Partly for the above reason, the public is not aware that UFO events are reported in far greater numbers than is commonly believed.

The majority of those who have witnessed truly puzzling UFO sightings generally are people who are quite sane, of good repute, well respected in their communities and often are well above average in education and technical training.

The study of UFOs has been grossly neglected but is eminently worthy of serious scientific study. We do not know, however, to which "branch" of science the study of UFOs properly belongs: do they "belong" to an astronomer any more than they do to a physicist or to a psychologist?

One of the greatest barriers to the study of UFOs is the often great reluctance of witnesses to the UFO experience to report the event for fear of ridicule. It has been estimated that for every UFO report there have been more than a dozen unreported events.

Much could be written in support of each of the above statements. A newsletter format, however, does not permit this; but one can summarize:

A real UFO phenomenon exists but by its very nature, it requires time and study to demonstrate its reality to one totally unfamiliar with it. It is something like trying to demonstrate to a life-long dweller in the tropics that snow really exists. It might take some doing, and at least, a willingness on his part to listen and learn.

With respect to the brevity and localized nature of the UFO event, Isaac Asimov has written*: "The trouble is, that whatever the UFO phenomenon is, it comes and goes unexpectedly. There is no way of examining it systematically. It appears suddenly and accidentally, is partially seen, and then is more or less inaccurately reported. We remain dependent on more or less anecdotal accounts."

True in the main, but it does not deny the existence of the UFO phenomenon. It simply says we have a tough problem on our hands. But Asimov is not correct on two points: some UFOs are quite completely (not partially) seen, and, more impor-

tantly, UFOs can be (and have been) studied systematically. The existence of UFOCAT [a computerized UFO data bank containing over 50,000 individual case entries] and its use for pattern studies, is but one example.

The Need for a Scientific UFO Newsletter at a Popular Level

There exists an enormously wide gap between the above Estimate of the Situation and the level of UFO information available to the interested public. The latter generally is that which can be found in the sensational tabloid press, the pulp magazines, men's adventure magazines and even girlie magazines. There are also, in many cases, the paperbacks written by persons far more dedicated to the "fast buck" than to scientific clarity. The sensational press coverage the UFO phenomenon has had for many years has been a viciously effective barrier to serious consideration by scientists and the educated public as well. Compounding this has been the great appeal the UFO subject has for the pseudo-religious, the "mystical trippers", and the unbalanced, itself a fitting study for the psychologist and the sociologist.

Clearly needed is a publication that can help bridge this gap, a forum for the qualified investigator of UFO reports to present his findings to the public and to his peers, concisely and accurately. How often one reads about or hears of a baffling UFO experience but has no means of determining to what extent—if at all—the story can be taken seriously? What checking has been done? How many witnesses were seriously, and independently, interviewed? What qualifications did the investigators have? Were they willing to expose a hoax or to demonstrate the fallacy of a given report? And, finally, what was their goal—a serious striving toward an understanding and solution of the problem, or merely to mystify, to titillate, or to "sell the product", and thus almost certainly to mislead?

Declaration of Principles of Publication

As Editor, and as a scientist, I would like to set down the principles and philosophy of the International UFO Reporter:

To treat the UFO "scene", the flow of reports, as the global phenomenon it is, but quite separately from theories advanced to explain the phenomenon. Since the most

popular current hypothesis by far is "extraterrestrial visitation", it must not be allowed to obfuscate the open study of the phenomenon. There might be *another* answer—even several answers!

The "Reporter" will be a concise, timely review of the current UFO phenomenon, dedicated to the observance of the scientific method and to the goal of solving one of the great mysteries of our time. Currently reported UFO activity and its investigation by technically qualified persons will be reviewed, briefly and accurately. Truly provocative cases will be followed up in successive issues just as far as the total situation permits.

A goal of the "Reporter" is public education. Young people of school and college age very frequently express deep interest in the UFO phenomenon. They should have available a source of information which is both authoritative and accurate, a publication which is respected and which therefore can be displayed openly in schools and libraries.

A cardinal principle of the "Reporter" and its staff is that funds which accrue from subscriptions be available to any serious investigator, and not only those associated with the Center for UFO Studies but to any person of demonstrated research ability who wishes to work in this provocative field.

Similarly, the pages of the "Reporter" are open to any serious UFO investigator, regardless of his or her association with organizations dedicated to furthering our knowledge of UFOs. It is hoped that the "Reporter" can serve as a forum for such individuals thus enhancing communication between them. This is a primary reason the newsletter format has been adopted. Exhaustive investigations of particular cases, or expositions of UFO theories, or lengthy statistical studies will be published by the Center for UFO Studies and, hopefully, by other organizations. Such studies will, of course, be summarized in the "Reporter", in line with keeping the public informed about current and continuing work.

Thus we launch this new publication, keeping in mind that

"To investigate is not necessarily to agree

To report is not necessarily to endorse

But not to inquire is to fail."

—Anon.

The International UFO Reporter is dedicated, first and foremost, to Inquiry.

* TV Guide, Dec. 14-20, 1975.

Double Encounter Questioned

In the Nov.-Dec. issue of the International UFO Reporter (p.4) we presented an account of two striking close encounters which occurred only two days apart, and to the same people. Each one in itself can be regarded as remarkable, but two in close succession is certainly more than doubly so; but on the basis of several long telephone interviews we felt the evidence was solid. And we still do. We have never, however, avoided criticism or swept under the carpet logical counter views on anything published in the REPORTER, and here is an example.

Bruce Martin, of Earlysville, Virginia, has called our attention to a letter in the April 2, 1982 issue of the Charlottesville paper, THE DAILY PROGRESS. In the letter, Jimmy Smith presents another view of one of the close encounters, that of March 30, 1982. We quote the relevant parts:

"On the same night, my three brothers and I were outside at approximately the same time that Ms. Morrison says she saw something. We live on Rt. 20 North and we are on the landing and take-off pattern for big passenger planes from the Charlottesville-Albermarle airport. At about 11:30 we saw a large jet come in from the east, then turn north. It was almost directly above us as it passed over. (It was confirmed that a 737 landed at that airport at 11:45).

"The plane was unusual in that it had a large number of brilliant lights on it. It was going very slow, it was barely making any noise, and it was quite low. It was so brightly lit that it looked like a flying Christmas tree. I told my brothers it must be in trouble because of the number of lights that were on. We have lived here all our lives and we have never seen a passenger plane lit up like this one...and we have seen many planes come and go at night... There also were white lights shining upwards from the base of the tail, like floodlights shining against the vertical part. If we had not seen that it had portions of the wings illuminated I suppose it could have been mistaken for something else...I would like to know why this aircraft had all those bright lights on when usually all that is showing is the familiar red and blue [green?] and maybe headlights."

One can jump to the conclusion, since the time of the sighting and of the plane on that night were similar, that the whole sighting has been solved (at least the first one; the second is less likely because of the boys' statement that they had never seen lights like that before in all the time they had lived near the airport).

Ms. Morrison replied to our query about the above that she does not live anywhere near the airport but some 25 miles to the southeast...(the plane was reported by the boys as having come from the east at a point considerably to the north of Charlottesville and then to have turned north) and that the craft she saw "literally paced my car turn-for-turn (she estimates there are more than a dozen turns) for about 20 blocks" and that it did not bank or turn to change direction. She feels certain that if a jet had been there, southeast of Charlottesville, and just 300-400 feet above the ground, she would have been able to identify it. Jets are not capable of hovering soundlessly or of reversing direction without turning.

As to the second Morrison sighting: Ms. Morrison maintains that this craft was viewed from her house and appeared to be stationary some 400 feet away, over a neighbor's house. This would not answer to a 737 landing some 25 miles away, even if it had had the same panoply of lights it had the previous night.

Ms. Morrison also points out that her sighting began some time before she got home, and lasted at least fifteen minutes. It is unlikely that the plane would have taken so long to land, and to have been flying so low so far from the airport.

The question has been raised, but in the absence of corroboration from other witnesses, it cannot be definitively settled. However, we find Ms. Morrison's reply convincing. □

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Glass Houses—Continued

searchlight; it was estimated to be at a distance of 85 to 90 yards and a height of 15 feet. A's "real-time" description of the searchlight's turning motion gave us a single rotation of 52 seconds.

When the searchlight penetrated the bedroom, A. woke up her husband (L. is a very sound sleeper and he didn't get to bed until after 3 a.m.). His reaction was that it was the Coast Guard. L. is familiar with helicopters from his service in Vietnam; but what he saw out of the window not only didn't look like a helicopter but couldn't be one because of this silence. They could hear nothing but the waves hitting the shore. After three or four minutes L. went back to sleep, telling his wife to keep an eye on the light and give him a report in the morning.

A. thought of calling the police to ask, "Why is there somebody shining their lights in our window?" But, it was now 4:25 a.m. and she thought "it's crazy" for anyone to do that, so she decided not to call.

After awhile a smaller object, also with three lights, emerged from or appeared over the first object. A. woke up L. again, saying, "You've got to see this."

They both watched this small trio of lights hover for a few minutes over the larger craft before disappearing in the darkness. A. said the smaller lights were pinkish, whereas the main lights were white (L. had reported 'yellow'). L. couldn't stay awake, again telling A. to "keep watching and see what happens."

A. kept watching another half-hour or so while the lights kept rotating. "Eventually, I made out a slightly visible outline which appeared oval-shaped and rather flat in density" (apparently indicating that there were no large differences in contrast between various parts of the oval). There were no features other than the lights. A. still thought, "It must be something ordi-

nary, but I couldn't recognize it as yet."

A. suddenly felt very conspicuous, what with the "searchlight" periodically aimed at her. The light now seemed to be focused into the bedroom for a longer period, so she decided to clock it the next time it came around. "I watched the digital clock [a "Grand Prix" LED that displays hours, minutes and seconds] and this was the peculiar thing: At 4:57 a.m. the light hit the window, and I watched the clock; I was feeling kind of queer...I don't remember exactly how long it was, because then the clock automatically flipped to 5 o'clock...I didn't think it was three minutes."

There is some confusion here, as earlier A. had written, "Then at exactly 4:57 the light shined very brightly into our room, but instead of rotating, it remained fixed on our window. I ducked down, suddenly feeling very conspicuous...I watched and waited for the light to pass and, when it did, the clocked clicked to 5:00. At that point I became nervous, thinking that whatever it was, was aware I was there, and I went back to bed."

From the bed she watched the craft begin to glide over the water to the southeast. "It moved about 20 or 30 feet and then stopped again, and remained stationary for another 10 or 15 minutes."

Then, at about 5:15, it started to move again, angling upward to the southeast, and disappeared within seconds. A. now knew it could not be any ordinary boat. "It glided like it was sliding over the water...it usually takes about 10 minutes for a barge to move from one side of the window to the other...but this glided away in seconds."

Quoting from A's letter, the last thing that happened is the most unforgettable. "As I was just beginning to fall asleep, I felt what seemed like a powerful electrical shock penetrate my entire body with a loud,

overpowering buzzing sound. It lasted only a few seconds but I'll never forget that feeling." Later, she told Dr. Hynek, "It was far more penetrating than putting a finger in an open light socket...more like a convulsion than a shock...I thought I was going to die...and I said, "Oh please God!" L. slept though all this.

Meanwhile, at 5:10 a.m., B. was getting up in the beach house to go to work. He observed, successively, through the east and south windows, a thumb-nail sized (at arm's length) oval, pink stationary light out on the lake above the horizon to the east-southeast. It struck him as odd, but he proceeded to get ready for work. Neither then, nor earlier, did B's dog, a Norwegian wolfhound who sleeps in the kitchen on the "inland" side of the beach house, act up. Neighbors with whom we spoke said they hadn't seen anything, very probably because they were asleep.

During the day following the sighting, A. was plagued by a persistent and unexplainable lassitude and drowsiness.

Both A. and L. drew the position and size of the "UFO" on clear overlays placed on Polaroid photos we took from the bedroom window. Using the known focal length of the Polaroid 440 model camera (114 mm) we could thus determine if the size they drew, from memory, was consistent with size and distance estimates they gave us earlier. Using the equation

$$\frac{\text{Focal Length}}{\text{Distance of Object}} = \frac{\text{Est. image size}}{\text{Actual Size of Object}}$$

we arrived at a distance of approximately 25 feet.

At this stage, the present investigators have not come up with any rational explanation of this UFO event. It would be most difficult indeed to ascribe the whole thing to hallucination or to some sort of mirage; this would not be in keeping with the results of the investigation.

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